

## Introducing ERWC 12: Portfolios and Metacognition

### MODULE TEXTS

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| Dover Beach, <i>Matthew Arnold</i>      | 1 |
| Ode on a Grecian Urn, <i>John Keats</i> | 3 |



## **Dover Beach**

By Matthew Arnold

*New Poems*, 1867

- 1 The sea is calm tonight.  
The tide is full, the moon lies fair  
Upon the straits; on the French coast the light  
Gleams and is gone; the cliffs of England stand,  
Glimmering and vast, out in the tranquil bay.  
Come to the window, sweet is the night-air!  
Only, from the long line of spray  
Where the sea meets the moon-blanch'd land,  
Listen! you hear the grating roar  
Of pebbles which the waves draw back, and fling,  
At their return, up the high strand,  
Begin, and cease, and then again begin,  
With tremulous cadence slow, and bring  
The eternal note of sadness in.
- 2 Sophocles long ago  
Heard it on the Ægean, and it brought  
Into his mind the turbid ebb and flow  
Of human misery; we  
Find also in the sound a thought,  
Hearing it by this distant northern sea.
- 3 The Sea of Faith  
Was once, too, at the full, and round earth's shore  
Lay like the folds of a bright girdle furled.  
But now I only hear  
Its melancholy, long, withdrawing roar,  
Retreating, to the breath  
Of the night-wind, down the vast edges drear  
And naked shingles of the world.

- 4 Ah, love, let us be true  
To one another! for the world, which seems  
To lie before us like a land of dreams,  
So various, so beautiful, so new,  
Hath really neither joy, nor love, nor light,  
Nor certitude, nor peace, nor help for pain;  
And we are here as on a darkling plain  
Swept with confused alarms of struggle and flight,  
Where ignorant armies clash by night.

## Ode on a Grecian Urn

By John Keats

*Annals of the Fine Arts*, January 1820

- 1   Thou still unravish'd bride of quietness,  
      Thou foster-child of silence and slow time,  
Sylvan historian, who canst thus express  
      A flowery tale more sweetly than our rhyme:  
What leaf-fring'd legend haunts about thy shape  
      Of deities or mortals, or of both,  
      In Tempe or the dales of Arcady?  
      What men or gods are these? What maidens loth?  
What mad pursuit? What struggle to escape?  
      What pipes and timbrels? What wild ecstasy?
- 2   Heard melodies are sweet, but those unheard  
      Are sweeter; therefore, ye soft pipes, play on;  
Not to the sensual ear, but, more endear'd,  
      Pipe to the spirit ditties of no tone:  
Fair youth, beneath the trees, thou canst not leave  
      Thy song, nor ever can those trees be bare;  
      Bold Lover, never, never canst thou kiss,  
Though winning near the goal yet, do not grieve;  
      She cannot fade, though thou hast not thy bliss,  
      For ever wilt thou love, and she be fair!
- 3   Ah, happy, happy boughs! that cannot shed  
      Your leaves, nor ever bid the Spring adieu;  
And, happy melodist, unwearied,  
      For ever piping songs for ever new;  
More happy love! more happy, happy love!  
      For ever warm and still to be enjoy'd,  
      For ever panting, and for ever young;  
All breathing human passion far above,  
      That leaves a heart high-sorrowful and cloy'd,  
      A burning forehead, and a parching tongue.

- 4 Who are these coming to the sacrifice?  
To what green altar, O mysterious priest,  
Lead'st thou that heifer lowing at the skies,  
And all her silken flanks with garlands drest?  
What little town by river or sea shore,  
Or mountain-built with peaceful citadel,  
Is emptied of this folk, this pious morn?  
And, little town, thy streets for evermore  
Will silent be; and not a soul to tell  
Why thou art desolate, can e'er return.
- 5 Attic shape! Fair attitude! with brede  
Of marble men and maidens overwrought,  
With forest branches and the trodden weed;  
Thou, silent form, dost tease us out of thought  
As doth eternity: Cold Pastoral!  
When old age shall this generation waste,  
Thou shalt remain, in midst of other woe  
Than ours, a friend to man, to whom thou say'st,  
"Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all  
Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know."